

Abdul Moid Khan, 66,

Rajdhani Nursery

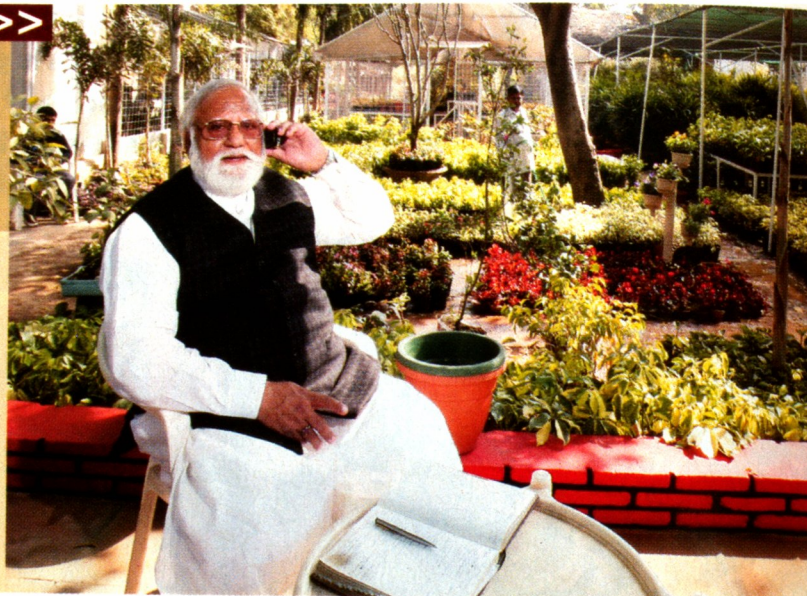
Specialisation: Supplying plants

Number of employees: 15

Revenues: Rs 1.5 crore per annum

THEN: Khan earned a modest Rs 150 for the sale of 500 plants 35 years ago. He later went into commercial horticulture in Shahjahanpur in Uttar Pradesh.

NOW: He runs one of the biggest nurseries in Delhi and hopes to double his turnover by next year. Says Khan, "You need to believe that your idea can be turned into a business."



HEMANT CHAWLA

handle everyday situations." An entrepreneur himself, Gupta was very keen when JLLM, the firm managing its facilities, suggested the name of retired army officer Colonel R.P. Suhag's company to provide security. "Suhag's Delta Group, with its high number of ex-servicemen, was the perfect choice for us," says Gupta.

Arvind Singhal, chairman of Technopak Advisors says, "You definitely see more entrepreneurship springing up. It's become viable and there's a need for more such companies." Select Citywalk President

and CEO Pranay Sinha feels other services aren't far behind. "We're going to see a lot more entrepreneurs who have figured out how to deliver customised services to specific niches of the market." For instance, when Select Citywalk was looking for plants for its mall, it contacted Abdul Moid Khan, who runs the Rajdhani Nursery in Jor Bagh in Delhi. Khan who believes that businesses are run with passion, completed the Rs 15 lakh order in a short span of 15 days, which included supplying 15 ft-tall trees like *ficus ben-jamina* and *plumeria alba* (champa).

In 2000, Gurgaon-based Sarita Anand and Shalini Bhatia, co-owners of Purple Crest, started a company to provide event management and visual merchandising services to corporates and soon extended that to malls. Today, they decorate nine to 10 malls in a year for major holidays, and have racked up revenues of Rs 1 crore. Lured by the footfalls malls attract, Anand's corporate clients increasingly want to hold their promotions and launches there.

Malls are also becoming innovation hotbeds. Consider this: Narasimha Suresh, the CEO of Telibrahma Convergent Communications is providing Bluetooth-based interactive solutions to 12 malls across the country. As a customer walks into a mall, he is asked to switch on the Bluetooth feature on his mobile. What follows is a host of deals and promotions. The entire mall is converted into a blu-fi zone, pretty much like wi-fi, and shoppers are provided information, videos, dating services and in-store deal coupons. "We saw value in retail becoming a media and thought of extending that experience to users' mobiles. Bluetooth does it at zero cost," says Suresh. Per mall, he reaches out to 2,000 customers daily and expects this to double over the next



GIREESH G V



N. Sathyanarayanan,

38, Central Parking Services

Specialisation: Parking solutions

Number of employees: 850

Revenues: Rs 45 crore per annum

THEN: In 1996, Honeywell executive Sathyanarayanan was contracted to develop parking solutions for a firm in Bangalore. He invested Rs 10,000 and founded Controlled Solutions.

NOW: His company, now known as Central Parking Services, manages 90,000 cars a day across 25 malls in India. Says Sathyanarayanan, "A bad parking experience spoils the entire trip."